

Gaps

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Gaps research: Dubbo e-waste refurb, back-shed, open Tuesdays & Saturdays

Historical/provenance register. This file is intentionally detailed and mixed-age. For current project truth, start with docs/CURRENT-STATE.md (docs/CURRENT-STATE.md), docs/PHASE-0-LAUNCH-GATES.md (docs/PHASE-0-LAUNCH-GATES.md), and docs/RESEARCH-INDEX.md (docs/RESEARCH-INDEX.md). Do not treat an older item below as current merely because it is detailed.

Section-note: duplicate I/J/L headings were renumbered to unique A-R headings on 2 Oct 2026; older research files may refer to the former duplicate letters by heading name.

Operating model being tested: accept high-quality old laptops, phones, tablets, TVs and electronics only; refurb and resell; open Tuesdays and Saturdays from a back shed.

Confidence key: [Found] = seen in an official/primary source this session. [Secondary] = directory/third-party page, verify. [Unknown] = couldn't establish, needs a phone call.

A. Big new finding: three regimes, and EPA is the smallest

1. EPA licence (waste) - probably NOT the blocker

- [Found] Waste storage only becomes a licensed activity at very high volumes. EPA's published thresholds: outside the Sydney/Newcastle/Wollongong "regulated area", 2,500 t stored on site at any time or 12,000 t/yr received. A shed will never get near this.
- [Found] Hazardous waste storage triggers at 5 tonnes on site (Schedule 1 cl 42(3)(a), as amended 2023). Whether damaged/end-of-life lithium batteries count as "hazardous waste" for this clause is [Unknown]; keep battery volumes tiny regardless.
- [Found] The NSW e-Waste Bill 2025 (would have licensed receiving >100 t/yr of e-waste) was defeated 18 Sep 2025. It is not law.
- [Unknown] Separate thresholds for waste processing/recovery (e.g. dismantling) weren't confirmed. Ask EPA: "refurb and part-out of ~X items/week, no shredding."
- Waste-law catch: Section 143 POEO makes it an offence to send waste to a place that can't lawfully be used as a waste facility. That "lawful" test also involves planning consent (below).

2. Planning / council - the real gating risk

- [Found] NSW Planning says a qualifying home business can be exempt development and can operate from an ancillary building such as a detached garage/studio.
- [Found] The standard home-business definition restricts amenity impacts from traffic, waste, noise, fumes etc., visible unsightly matter, signage, and ordinary on-site retail of goods not produced there (online retailing is allowed).
- [Found] Dubbo Regional LEP 2022 caps a home business at 30 m².
- [Found] NSW planning law separately defines goods repair and reuse premises as premises principally used to collect, repair or refurbish goods for sale/hire/swap.

- [Found] NSW EPA said in July 2026 that accepting old material and separating/sorting it can meet the definition of a waste facility; it also said a below-EPL-threshold scrap business can still require development consent.
- Implication: Tue/Sat intake is not automatically prohibited, but the exact classification of this collect/refurbish/resell model is unresolved. Council must decide whether it is an exempt home business, another permissible use requiring consent, or a waste/resource use.
- [Unknown] Exact statutory zoning/site constraints for the property.
- Cheapest operating design while this is resolved: pre-approved intake only, low traffic, no unattended bin, no outdoor stockpile, no walk-in retail showroom, online sales, and rejected items leave with the customer.
- [Unknown] DA/CDC cost and timeline if Council says consent is needed.

3. Second-hand dealer licence (NSW Fair Trading) - VERIFIED, updated Sept 2026

- [Found] Needed to buy, sell or exchange prescribed goods, including electronic goods (phones, laptops, tablets). Not needed for whitegoods, video games, non-portable items, or anyone who will "engage in recycling and rubbish collection programs".
- [Found] Fees (2026-27): \$692 (1 yr), \$1,574 (3 yr), \$2,456 (5 yr) for a new licence. This replaces my earlier \$600-\$2,200 estimate.
- [Found] Licence can be held by an individual, partnership or corporation, and belongs to that legal entity. Premises used for business and storage must be notified. Fit-and-proper checks apply to the person or each director.
- [Found] Obligations: supplier ID and signed ownership statement, electronic records (reported to police within 3 days), signage, and a 14-day hold during which goods can't be altered.
- [Unknown] Whether a free-collection -> refurb -> resell -> recycle-the-rest model counts as a "recycling program". Ask Fair Trading (13 32 20) in writing, or apply for an exemption (licensing.exemptions@customerservice.nsw.gov.au).
- [Unknown] Whether the 14-day no-alteration hold blocks wiping and repair if you're licensed.
- [Unknown] Whether Avance or any related business already holds a licence. Operating as a trading name of a licensed entity could work, but a brand name alone doesn't remove the requirement, and it raises liability and conflict-of-interest questions for that business.
- Don't budget the \$692 yet.
- Why it matters: public drop-offs of phones/laptops are where stolen goods turn up. Business-client-only intake with a signed ownership/transfer form is far safer.

B. What happens to the leftovers (the junk problem)

- [Found] Current operator evidence: NSW Police's 19 Feb 2026 scrap-metal register lists Scrap Metal Services Pty Ltd / Australian Metal Recycling (AMR), registration SM-0759, at 34 Mountbatten Drive, Dubbo, managed by Gordon Matthews. AMR's own current site calls Dubbo "Formerly Matthews Metal Management."
- [Found] AMR current e-waste offer: AMR says e-waste is recycled for free. Its current official materials list explicitly includes TVs, computers/laptops, monitors, smart phones/tablets and printers/scanners.
- [Found] AMR lithium exclusion: its materials list says electronic waste excluding lithium ion, and lithium batteries are separately listed among materials it does not accept.
- [Unknown] battery handling for whole devices: the site does not explain whether batteries must be removed from laptops/phones/tablets or whether devices with embedded batteries are accepted.
- [Unknown] CRT-specific rule: TVs and monitors are listed generally, but CRTs are not separately identified. The old Matthews directory's no-TV/no-printer entry should be treated as stale because it conflicts with current AMR policy.
- [Unknown] exact downstream chain: AMR does not publicly name the recycler/facility that receives Dubbo e-waste after collection, or say whether Dubbo itself dismantles/shreds any electronics.

- [Found — historical] Matthews/NTCRS: historical council records show Matthews Metal Management previously provided NTCRS-funded e-waste collection, and a historical Matthews Parkes listing pointed users to TechCollect's accepted-product rules. Historical TechCollect NSW recycler pools included Sims and TES-AMM, but no source maps Matthews loads to a particular recycler.
- [Found — current TechCollect]: ANZRP's 2024-25 report names ACE Recycling Group and Sircel as its NSW recyclers. TechCollect's current public NSW collection-partner list does not identify AMR, Matthews or Dubbo.
- [Research lead, NOT a confirmed AMR route]: Sircel Parkes is the strongest regional candidate found because it is a current Central West e-waste processor with documented Parkes/Narromine/NetWaste activity and is a current TechCollect NSW recycler. No source found links AMR/Scrap Metal Services to Sircel.
- [Research lead, NOT a confirmed AMR route]: ACE Recycling Group is the other current TechCollect NSW recycler (St Marys/Heatherbrae) with documented e-waste dismantling, but no AMR link was found.
- Proof required to close the gap: an AMR dispatch/weight docket, certificate of recycling, downstream invoice/manifest, AS 5377 subcontractor record, current co-regulator partner record, or written AMR response naming the legal entity and first facility.
- [Unknown] NTCRS / AS 5377 status: no current public evidence found that AMR Dubbo is an NTCRS collection point/contracted recycler or that the Dubbo yard itself is AS 5377 certified.
- [Unknown] data destruction: no public AMR evidence found for NIST-style sanitisation, drive shredding or serial-number-level destruction certificates. Treat AMR as material recycling, not secure ITAD, until confirmed.
- [Unknown] loose PCBs, mixed loads, pickup minimums, business volume limits and whether certificates of recycling are available for small drop-offs.
- [Found] Corporate split: a March 2025 regional tender listed InfraBuild Recycling (OneSteel Recycling Pty Limited, ABN 28 002 707 262) and Scrap Metal Services Pty Ltd (ABN 51 640 765 091) as separate bidders. InfraBuild still owns/uses the Matthews Metal Management business name and has an old Dubbo branch page, but AMR is the strongest evidence for the current physical Dubbo yard operator.
- NTCRS gives households and small businesses free recycling of TVs and computers at collection points [Found]; recyclers must be AS 5377 certified. Whylandra remains a fallback if its business-volume rules allow the load.
- Phones: MobileMuster is another recycling route [Secondary].
- Batteries: B-cycle/council routes for lithium batteries; AMR accepts non-lithium batteries but not lithium batteries. Don't stockpile.
- [Found benchmark] Under the Australian NTCRS, first-stage recycling normally dismantles/shreds/sorts TVs and computers into glass, metals, plastics, batteries, PCBs and toner; specialist fractions then go to processors in Australia or approved overseas facilities. This explains what a compliant downstream chain can look like, but it is not proof of AMR's exact chain.
- [Found — TechCollect reuse policy] TechCollect says all computers, accessories and TVs collected through its normal recycling stream are recycled in Australia and not sold as second-hand products for reuse. It tells people to donate/pass on working current equipment before bringing it to TechCollect.
- [Found — ANZRP reuse outside normal TechCollect intake] ANZRP supports reuse through PonyUp for Good, The Reconnect Project and The Laptop Initiative. PonyUp triages, erases data, refurbishes and remarkets viable equipment, then sends only non-reusable devices to ANZRP for recycling.
- Implication for Dubbo eWaste: the strongest strategic position is to sit upstream of the recycling stream and capture working/repairable value before an item is formally surrendered as e-waste. See docs/TECHCOLLECT-REUSE-DEEP-DIVE.md.
- Takeaway: test AMR first as the local zero-value electronics/metal downstream outlet, but do not describe its final recycling pathway until it names the next processor. See docs/WHAT-HAPPENS-TO-EWASTE.md and the exact-recipient investigation in docs/AMR-DUBBO-DOWNSTREAM-FORENSIC.md.

TVs specifically (you said you want them)

- AMR's current official list includes TVs as e-waste, so the old claim that the local outlet does not take TVs is no longer reliable. CRTs are still not separately identified. For your intake model, working modern flat-screen/smart TVs remain the safer category until AMR confirms CRT handling and battery/electronics rules.

C. Safety and liability

- [Found] Fire and Rescue NSW says damaged lithium-ion batteries include swollen/bulging, leaking, cracked/dented/punctured/crushed, overheated, wet/submerged and fire-exposed batteries/devices. It says never use or charge a damaged battery.
- [Found] B-cycle says badly damaged/swollen batteries must not be taken to ordinary B-cycle drop-off points.
- Phase 0 decision: do not operate a public battery drop-off and reject loose lithium batteries plus damaged/swollen/wet/fire-affected battery devices at intake.
- If battery damage is discovered after intake, stop use/charging and follow FRNSW/B-cycle/accredited-collector guidance rather than improvising storage.
- No unattended/overnight charging; use compatible/compliant chargers and a non-combustible test area.
- [Found] Existing tenancy evidence records moisture/mould/water-damage concerns in the intended shed area. It should not hold valuable resale stock or unwiped data devices until it is demonstrably dry, secure and suitable.
- [Found] business.gov.au says standard home insurance often does not cover business activity and public liability may be needed when clients visit the home.
- [Unknown] Public/product liability premium and whether an insurer will accept this exact home electronics activity.

D. Selling side

- eBay: fee rules changed in 2026. One calculator says low-volume private sellers (under about A\$25k/yr) pay no transaction fee, while "Pro" business sellers pay roughly 13.4% GST-inclusive plus a fixed fee [Secondary]. A business reselling sourced stock probably counts as a business seller. Verify on eBay's current fee page.
- Facebook Marketplace / local sales: low fees, but local walk-in sales may trigger the planning "retail" issue above.
- GST: registration is compulsory at A\$75,000 turnover as I understand it [confirm with ATO]. Parris Tech Services' existing ABN covers the basics.
- Consumer law: ACL consumer guarantees apply to second-hand goods; plan a short warranty/returns policy.

E. Data, device viability and supply side

- [Found] ACSC recommends erasing data before disposal and notes SSDs can require manufacturer-specific sanitisation steps. ASD's current media guidance and NIST SP 800-88 Rev. 2 are stronger references for a documented business workflow.
- Phase 0 workflow: every data-bearing item gets an intake ID and begins in UNWIPED — RESTRICTED; account locks are cleared legitimately; sanitisation is media-appropriate; result is verified and recorded; only then can the item move to repair/parts/resale.
- Marketing: use documented secure data erasure initially, not "certified data destruction" unless later accreditation/process genuinely supports that claim.
- [Found] Apple: Activation Lock must be removed for another person to activate the device. Reject unresolved locked Apple gear for resale.
- [Found] Android: device protection can require the previous account after factory reset. Do not retain donor passwords; have legitimate account/device protection cleared as part of handover.
- [Found] Windows: normal Windows 10 support ended 14 October 2025. For ordinary refurbished Windows sales in late 2026, Windows 11 compatibility should be the default target; older machines need a specific Linux/vintage/parts/use case.

- [Found] Phones: ACMA says 3G-only and some older 4G phones are unusable/blocked after the 3G shutdown if they cannot meet emergency-calling requirements. Network/000 compatibility must be checked before resale.
- Ownership transfer: every item should have a source/authority-to-transfer record even if Fair Trading ultimately confirms the recycling exemption.
- [Unknown] For school/business fleet sources, what internal disposal approvals each organisation requires.
- [Unknown] Advance conflict-of-interest/employment permission until checked.

F. Government interest in Dubbo e-waste

- [Found] NSW DPIRD has published an "E-waste recycling Dubbo" investment pitch positioning Dubbo as an e-waste processing hub. Not directly relevant to a shed, but suggests the region is receptive and there may be contacts or programs. Worth one email.

G. Updated "cheapest possible" cost picture (estimates)

Item | Estimate

Wipe tools and cert template | \$0-\$300

Basic safe test/storage setup | Unknown – use existing suitable gear where possible; do not buy a public battery bin in Phase 0

Public liability insurance | \$800-\$1,500/yr (get quotes)

Second-hand dealer licence, if required | \$692 (1 yr) VERIFIED; don't budget until confirmed

DA / council consent, if required | Unknown

Downstream leftovers | Potentially \$0/low-cost for eligible NTCRS/MobileMuster streams; AMR/commercial terms still need confirmation

H. Call list (in this order)

1. Dubbo Regional Council planning: describe the exact pre-approved Tue/Sat model (under 30 m², no public bin, no outside stockpile, no walk-in retail, online sales) and ask whether it is exempt home business, another use requiring consent, or a waste/resource activity. Ask for the answer in writing.
2. NSW Fair Trading (13 32 20): "Does a free-collection, refurb, resell, recycle-the-rest model fall under the 'recycling and rubbish collection programs' exemption? Can wiping happen during the 14-day hold? Can I operate under an already-licensed entity?"
3. NSW EPA (131 555): thresholds for refurb/dismantling at tiny scale; whether damaged lithium batteries count as hazardous waste for storage.
4. Joe (Bendigo): what he pays for sorted lots; any minimum volumes; freight.
5. Australian Metal Recycling (former Matthews Dubbo), (02) 6882 1033: confirm the Dubbo yard follows AMR's published list; then ask where the material physically goes next, whether Dubbo dismantles/shreds anything, the downstream recycler's legal name/location, NTCRS/co-reg relationship, AS 5377 certificate/scope, battery-removal rule, CRT/toner rules, data-destruction options, export destinations, pickup minimums and weight/recycling certificates.
6. Whylandra: commercial e-waste fee and NTCRS limits for a business drop-off.
7. Insurers: public liability for home-shed e-waste refurb with visitors.
8. Avance: conflict-of-interest check.

I-A. Surrounding-town e-waste pathways — researched 2 Oct 2026

Full evidence table and sources: docs/REGIONAL-EWASTE-PATHWAYS.md
(docs/REGIONAL-EWASTE-PATHWAYS.md).

- [Found] NetWaste regional layer: NetWaste covers 25 Central/Western NSW councils and says Sims Metal Management collects e-waste from the majority of NetWaste councils, while several councils use individual arrangements.
- [Found] Current NetWaste e-waste points near Dubbo: Whylandra (Dubbo), Wellington, Narromine, Parkes, Daroobalgie/Forbes, Ewenmar/Warren, Mudgee, Gulgong and Kandos.
- [Found] Dubbo Regional Council: domestic e-waste/old TVs are free at Whylandra and Wellington; village/rural facilities also accept household quantities of domestic e-waste where that stream is offered.
- [Found] Narromine: 2026/27 fee schedule lists domestic e-waste — no charge at the waste facility.
- [Found] Coonamble Shire: Coonamble, Gulgong and Quambone pages all say sorted e-waste can be dropped without charge; Quambone is domestic-only. Their exact downstream contractor is [Unknown].
- [Found] Parkes: its waste-facility fee schedule lists sorted e-waste as no charge. Important nuance: the CRC itself says it does not accept TVs/computers; e-waste is handled through the wider waste-facility stream. Parkes' 2026 bulky collection also separated e-waste from general bulky waste.
- [Found] Mid-Western: Council specifically directs e-waste to Gulgong Waste Facility, Kandos Waste Facility or the Tip Shop at Mudgee Waste Facility. This is the clearest nearby public reuse-oriented pathway found.
- [Found] Warren: Ewenmar is on NetWaste's current e-waste collection-point list.
- [Found] Forbes: Daroobalgie is on NetWaste's current e-waste collection-point list.
- [Unknown] Gilgandra: current Council 2026/27 free-item material does not explicitly list e-waste and NetWaste's current e-waste map does not list Gilgandra, even though historical regional documents show participation. Call Council before treating a permanent e-waste service as current.
- [Secondary/Unknown] Nyngan: Bogan's official pages confirm the waste facility and NetWaste participation, and a current secondary council-data service reports free domestic e-waste, but the official page surfaced here does not state it and NetWaste's current e-waste map omits Nyngan. Verify directly.
- [Historical] St Marys: NetWaste's 2023–2027 strategy recorded an earlier e-waste route under the scrap-metal contract where material was shredded at Sims' St Marys depot, with a further recovery pilot involving E-cycle Solutions. Do not treat this as the confirmed 2026 route; the old contract dates have passed.
- [Found] Sims model: Sims E-Recycling publicly describes both reuse and end-of-life recycling of computers, TVs, phones and other electronics, but current public sources do not show the exact final destination/fraction recovery for each surrounding council.

Strategic implication

The surrounding councils already solve much of the household disposal problem. The stronger Dubbo E-Waste proposition is reuse before recycling: collect good devices before they enter council cages, document ownership/data wiping, refurbish/resell/donate them, and send only end-of-life remainder downstream.

New unknowns to resolve

- Which surrounding councils' current contracts permit a separate reuse stream before recycler pickup?
- Who legally owns devices once deposited at each council facility?
- Can a local refurbisher receive diverted items under a formal agreement?
- Annual e-waste tonnes/item counts by council, and estimated reusable share.
- Exact current downstream contractor and final destination for Coonamble, Gilgandra, Nyngan, Warren, Parkes, Forbes, Narromine and Mid-Western.
- Commercial e-waste prices/limits across surrounding facilities.

Regional downstream gaps narrowed — 2 Oct 2026

New evidence closes part of the earlier "what happens next?" gap:

- [Found] Parkes: Council explicitly records e-waste from Parkes Landfill being collected by Sircel. Sircel's Parkes facility and detailed processing method are public.
- [Found] Coonamble (2025): Council explicitly records an arrangement with Matthews Metals Dubbo for e-waste and batteries.
- [Found/Historical] NetWaste: an older regional contract explicitly described e-waste being shredded at Sims St Marys, while NetWaste's current page still says Sims collects e-waste for the majority of member councils.
- [Unknown] Dubbo 2026: the exact current contractor after the Matthews contract expiry remains unconfirmed.
- [Unknown] Council reuse rights: no public contract found yet showing whether a local third-party refurbisher can take suitable devices before the contracted recycler.
- [Unknown] ownership: exact point at which deposited electronics become Council/contractor property needs council/legal confirmation.
- [Unknown] quantities: current annual e-waste tonnes and reusable-device share by council remain to be obtained.
- [Unknown] Narromine: Sircel/Parkes has demonstrably handled Narromine regional e-waste, but current exclusive routing is not published.
- [Important distinction] Access Recycling won a 2025 regional scrap-metal tender; this is not evidence it replaced Sims for e-waste.

Sircel reuse-first model — high-priority unknowns to resolve

Detailed research: docs/SIRCEL-ITAD-REUSE-MODEL.md (docs/SIRCEL-ITAD-REUSE-MODEL.md).

Sircel's public material confirms the broad model — unique load tracking, triage before destruction, Blancco sanitisation, hardware testing, reuse via charity/approved brokers, FMV/buy-back, then mechanical recycling for failures — but it does not publish the operational thresholds that would be most useful for Dubbo E-Waste.

Ask Sircel/ITAD directly:

- exact laptop/desktop pass/fail test list;
- minimum CPU/RAM/storage/age specifications for resale;
- cosmetic/battery grading rules;
- which repairs/upgrades are economical;
- what percentage of incoming PCs/laptops are actually reused;
- how fair-market-value/buy-back is calculated;
- broker/charity channel rules;
- how Autopilot/MDM/Activation Lock/BitLocker failures are treated;
- whether Parkes performs ITAD locally or transfers reuse candidates elsewhere;
- whether Sircel would accept pre-triaged regional devices or partner with a Dubbo first-stage refurbisher;
- minimum pallet/weight/collection volumes and certificate/reporting costs;
- current contracting entity and commercial continuity while Sircel remains under receivership/administration.

Sircel reuse-partner downstream trace — new findings

Full research: docs/SIRCEL-REUSE-PARTNERS-WHERE-DOES-IT-GO.md
(docs/SIRCEL-REUSE-PARTNERS-WHERE-DOES-IT-GO.md).

- [Found] Good360 link: Good360's 2024 Annual Report and 2025 Digital Access Report name Sircel as a product donor in its digital-inclusion/device program.
- [Found] Good360 downstream model: devices are securely wiped/tested/refurbished, matched to eligible charities/disadvantaged schools, then distributed locally to people in need. Named real-world endpoints include students, social-housing residents, employment-service participants, family-violence support and disaster-recovery communities.
- [Found] Compnow refurbishment detail: Good360's named refurbishment partner Compnow documents wipe -> condition/hardware test -> repair/battery replacement where required -> OS reinstall -> accessory completion -> box/label -> Good360 distribution.
- [Found] National Device Bank evolution: WorkVentures + Good360 + Good Things Australia now operate a national donated-device pathway with secure refurbishment, Blancco/NIST-grade sanitisation, community distribution and digital support.
- [Unknown] exact Sircel allocation: no public evidence says how many of Sircel's 2,350 FY24 reused devices went to Good360, other charities, client redeployment or commercial brokers.
- [Unknown] approved brokers: Sircel still does not publicly name the brokers that buy reuse-qualified assets or where those brokers resell them.
- [Unknown] serial-level second-life tracking: Sircel's own ESG report says visibility ends once assets enter partner operational control.
- Opportunity for Dubbo: design serial-level outcome tracking beyond handoff so a reused device can be reported through sale/donation/return/recycling rather than simply marked "reused".

J. Reuse-first benchmark models

Detailed research: docs/REUSE-MODELS-PONYUP-RECONNECT-LAPTOP-INITIATIVE.md.

- [Found] PonyUp for Good: business-focused IT asset disposition and reuse. Strongest reuse target is recent corporate technology, typically around 2–5 years old. It offers collection, serialised asset registers, Blancco/Aiken sanitisation, certificates, refurbishment and remarketing; equipment with no reuse potential goes to ANZRP/accredited recycling. PonyUp's published impact material says roughly 32–32.5% of collected equipment has been reused.
- [Found] Reconnect Project: accepts phones/tablets of any age/condition and laptops under about 8 years, then performs real device-level triage, repair, donor-parts harvesting, Blancco erasure and either affordable resale or distribution through partner agencies. Its current distribution page reports 4,800+ devices distributed. Unrepairable remnants go to Australian reproprocessors.
- [Found] Laptop Initiative: highly selective direct-reuse model for business-donated laptops, generally ≤ 4 years old, in good working condition, with charger/webcam and already wiped/prepared. It says it does not normally repair laptops after gifting. It minimises warehousing by matching incoming donations to charity demand and moving devices within days. It announced a 1,000-laptop milestone in September 2026.
- [Found] Different economics: PonyUp funds itself through commercial services and resale; Reconnect uses repair income, refurbished sales, grants/donations and business/government work; The Laptop Initiative gifts devices and relies on sponsorship/donations/volunteers rather than resale.
- [Implication] Best Phase 0 hybrid for Dubbo: copy PonyUp's business-first sourcing and traceability, Reconnect's device-level triage/parts hierarchy, and The Laptop Initiative's strict acceptance criteria/fast inventory turnover. Do not copy Reconnect's broad intake/employment model or TLI's donation-only economics at launch.
- [Unknown] Partnership opportunity: whether PonyUp, Reconnect or The Laptop Initiative would accept a Dubbo regional feeder/triage partner. Ask directly.

K. Good360 / Compnow / National Device Bank / Dubbo — deep-dive findings

Full research: docs/GOOD360-COMPNOW-NATIONAL-DEVICE-BANK-DUBBO.md
(docs/GOOD360-COMPNOW-NATIONAL-DEVICE-BANK-DUBBO.md).

Confirmed

- [Found] Sircel -> Good360 ecosystem: Good360's 2024 reporting names Sircel among digital-access product donors. This proves a Good360 connection, but not the quantity or exact Sircel devices supplied.
- [Found] Compnow -> Good360: Compnow is Good360's named Education Partner/refurbishment partner. Its documented workflow is nationwide corporate fleet pickup -> certified wipe -> cosmetic/hardware test -> repairs/battery replacement/parts matching -> OS reinstall -> source missing charger -> individual box/label -> Good360 distribution.
- [Found] Cross-subsidy: Good360/Compnow can on-sell unsuitable donated categories and return proceeds to Good360; National Device Bank reporting also describes some residual-value devices being sold to help fund free devices.
- [Found] National Device Bank: launched 7 Aug 2025 by WorkVentures, Good360 Australia and Good Things Australia. Current standard free laptop spec is i5 6th gen+, 8GB+ RAM, 128GB+ SSD, Wi-Fi, webcam/mic and 13.3"+ display.
- [Found] Current NDB donor threshold: the NDB's public donor page currently asks for contributions of more than 50 devices. WorkVentures' broader CircularIT service can scope smaller/flexible fleets separately.
- [Found] WorkVentures ITAD: secure collection, Blancco/NIST-style sanitisation, serialised certificates, grading, refurbishment/resale/donation, R2-certified recycling for failures and impact reporting.
- [Found] NSW Device Bank: 12-month 2026 pilot using surplus NSW Government laptops, delivered through NSW Telco Authority + WorkVentures + Good Things Australia. General public cannot apply directly; registered NSW charities/NFPs on the ACNC register can request devices or apply as digital-literacy providers.
- [Found] First NSW rollout: The Place Charlestown was the first publicly announced community partner in Sep 2026, distributing 30 refurbished laptops with 12 months of data, digital-skills training and IT support.
- [Found] Dubbo Support Center: direct Good Things partner; selected for Digital Sisters; \$3,000 and \$5,200 Building Digital Skills grants in 2025 plus \$1,000 Get Online Week grant; now ACNC-registered. It appears to satisfy the NSW Device Bank's published organisation-level eligibility criterion, but no application/selection is publicly confirmed.
- [Found] Digital Nebula - Dubbo: received \$3,000 Building Digital Skills and \$1,000 Get Online Week funding from Good Things in 2025. Its current ABN record is a discretionary trading trust rather than an ACNC charity, so direct NSW Device Bank eligibility is not established.
- [Found] Existing Dubbo need/use: Aboriginal Housing Office's Services Our Way program distributed 90+ refurbished laptops and published a 2026 Dubbo recipient using one for TAFE study/employment. DRC/VERTO also ran Laptop to Launch digital-skills training in Dubbo/Wellington.
- [Found] Good360 already reaches Dubbo through non-device programs: historical LeaderLife distribution, Little Wings support to a Dubbo family, and a NSW NGO Flood Recovery grant with Dubbo in Good360's approved service area.

Still unknown

- Whether Sircel is still an active Good360 digital-device donor in 2026.
- How many Sircel assets went to Good360 and whether any Sircel asset was processed by Compnow.
- Whether any Good360 Digital Divide/Laptop Launchpad device has already been distributed in Dubbo.
- Whether the National Device Bank has delivered devices in Dubbo.
- Whether the NSW Device Bank has selected a Dubbo partner; no public Dubbo rollout was found as of 2 Oct 2026.
- Whether Dubbo Support Center has applied to either device bank.

- Whether WorkVentures/Good360 would accept a small Dubbo refurbisher as a local technical, aggregation or final-mile partner.
- Whether Compnow currently collects corporate IT fleets from Dubbo and the minimum economical regional volume.
- Whether Digital Nebula could participate through another pathway despite not obviously meeting the NSW Device Bank's ACNC criterion.

L. Five biggest unresolved questions after all-chat synthesis — 2 Oct 2026

Full synthesis: docs/MASTER-FINDINGS-ALL-CHATS.md (docs/MASTER-FINDINGS-ALL-CHATS.md).

1. Can the exact Phase 0 home-site model operate lawfully and safely?

Need the definitive Council classification/property planning answer, lease/landlord position, demonstrably dry/secure workspace and insurer acceptance.

2. Does the NSW second-hand dealer regime apply to the exact collect → wipe → refurbish/resell → recycle model?

Need Fair Trading's written answer on the recycling-program exemption, donated/free goods, 14-day hold and whether wiping/repair counts as alteration.

3. Where does the genuine end-of-life material physically go?

Need AMR Dubbo's first downstream facility, embedded-lithium rule, NTCRS/AS 5377 relationship, CRT/commercial terms and documentation; also need Dubbo Council's current post-June-2025 e-waste contractor/reuse rights.

4. Is there enough repeatable profitable supply in Dubbo?

Only a measured pilot can establish reusable-device rate, repair labour, sale values, stock days, returns, downstream costs and margin per labour hour.

5. Which organisations will actually partner with a Dubbo reuse operator, and on what terms?

Promising leads include Dubbo Support Center, Good Things, WorkVentures, Good360, National/NSW Device Bank, ANZRP/TechCollect, Sircel, councils and local businesses/MSPs, but volume thresholds, responsibilities, warranty, reporting, logistics and commercial terms are still unconfirmed.

M. NSW public-school eWaste / EDConnect gap — researched 2 Oct 2026

Full deep dive: docs/NSW-EDUCATION-EWASTE-DUBBO-LAPTOPS.md (docs/NSW-EDUCATION-EWASTE-DUBBO-LAPTOPS.md).

Confirmed

- [Found] NSW public schools use a dedicated Department eWaste contract accessed through EDConnect / the Department eWaste application.
- [Found] Schools take stock, obtain approval, submit the collection request, centralise the equipment and sign off collection.

- [Found] The vendor plans a cost-efficient collection schedule and the form asks for quantities so the appropriate team/truck can be arranged.
- [Found] The current operational guide says school-side wiping/destruction of hard drives is no longer required under this process.
- [Found] The vendor must data sanitise all collected hard drives, provide a sanitisation certificate and provide a Settlement Report.
- [Found] Department policy separately allows redistribution of unused Department-allocated devices for students in need before disposal.
- [Found] Whole-of-government Contract 9826 permits disposal outcomes including reuse through sale/donation, supplier supply-chain recovery and recycling through a proven third party.
- [Found] Current C9826 standalone-service suppliers include ACT Logistics, G1 Asset Management, Greenbox, Lifecycle Plus, Sims Lifecycle Services and WorkVentures.
- [Found] The NSW Device Bank is a separate 2026 government laptop-reuse program delivered through WorkVentures, with about 2,800 initial laptops plus about 2,500 more expected during the 12-month term.

Still unknown

- [Unknown] Current dedicated NSW Education school eWaste vendor name/ABN.
- [Unknown] Whether the Education contract is actually placed under C9826.
- [Unknown] Which contractor physically collects from Dubbo/Orana schools.
- [Unknown] Regional consolidation depot / first receiving facility.
- [Unknown] First testing/refurbishment facility.
- [Unknown] First material-recycling facility.
- [Unknown] Whether AMR, Sircel, Sims, WorkVentures, ACT Logistics or another provider is in the Dubbo school chain.
- [Unknown] Percentage of devices reused/remarketed, donated, parted, recycled or destroyed.
- [Unknown] Whether residual-value credits are returned to Education/schools.
- [Unknown] Whether normal EDConnect school eWaste can enter the NSW Device Bank.
- [Unknown] Exact fields in the required Settlement Report.

Strategic implication

NSW public schools should not be treated as an easy Phase 0 donation source. The opportunity is a later approved ITAD/reuse role: vendor, subcontractor, formal regional pilot or approved Device Bank/reuse pathway.

Evidence needed to close it

- current contract award / purchase order;
- vendor name;
- blank/redacted Settlement Report;
- blank/redacted sanitisation certificate;
- Dubbo/Orana collection statistics;
- downstream facility names;
- asset outcome breakdown.

N. Local reuse/resale gap and council barriers

Detailed research:

- docs/DUBBO-WELLINGTON-NARROMINE-TRANGIE-REUSE-PROGRAMS.md
- docs/WHY-COUNCIL-ELECTRONICS-REUSE-IS-HARD.md
- docs/PONYUP-SECONDBITE-DUBBO.md

Found

- Dubbo/Wellington: Council has formally planned/business-cased reuse shops, but no current official electronics-specific test/wipe/refurb/resale operation was verified.
- Narromine: 2024 Garage Sale Trail delivered 47 sales/stalls and 4,231 items reused/sold. This demonstrates reuse without Council taking custody.
- Trangie: current documented electronics activity is small-item recycling; no specialist reuse/resale program was found.
- Cessnock comparative evidence: a 2026 NSW council report identified safety, compliance, security and financial risk as reasons councils have shifted away from operating reuse shops directly. It listed minimum two staff, security, electrical test/tag, product liability, POS, capital works and ongoing compliance among requirements.
- NSW EPA reuse evidence: reuse is labour-intensive but socially valuable — 25x more jobs per tonne than recycling in the 2022-23 study.
- Dumping risk: NSW EPA says bad/illegal charity donations cost millions annually.
- Battery risk: NSW EPA reported 332 lithium-ion incidents in 2025 and continuing truck/waste-facility fires in 2026.
- PonyUp/SecondBite: PonyUp contributes 50% of profits to SecondBite; the computers do not flow to SecondBite.
- Dubbo SecondBite link: Connecting Community Services is a current SecondBite partner and separately provides free computer/internet access and basic skills help.

Unknown / direct-contact questions

- Current status/funding/timeline of Whylandra and Wellington reuse shops.
- Whether either planned shop would accept/test electronics.
- Whether Council contracts allow pre-disposal diversion to a third-party refurbisher.
- Whether Narromine would support an electronics-specific reuse pilot.
- Exact full e-waste acceptance at Trangie versus Narromine.
- Whether Connecting Community Services wants refurbished devices for clients.
- Whether PonyUp currently services any Dubbo/Orana fleets.
- Whether PonyUp, Reconnect or Laptop Initiative would use a Dubbo feeder/triage partner.

O. Fliptech regional-hub feasibility

Detailed research:

- docs/FLIPTECH-DUBBO-BRANCH-FEASIBILITY.md

Found

- Fliptech Australia Pty Ltd is an active NSW company (ABN 54 653 401 024) headquartered in Brookvale.
- Current public positioning is secure IT decommissioning / ITAD, not merely generic e-waste recycling.

- Public material supports: hardware buybacks, paid/subsidised data erasure, NIST-aligned sanitisation, asset reports/certificates, refurbishment, donation, official resale channels and material recycling.
- Fliptech has historical public evidence of national expansion ambition and later media described nationwide clients.
- Current public location material still shows Brookvale as the only identified Fliptech location.
- No current public franchise, dealer, authorised-partner or regional-branch program was found.
- Fliptech already works with Royal Far West, giving it a real rural/regional-NSW social-reuse dimension.
- NSW Government currently markets Dubbo as an e-waste recycling investment opportunity, citing transport connectivity, industrial land and regional aggregation potential.
- Dubbo Regional Council describes a 125,000+ regional catchment; Leading Edge Data Centres says Dubbo has 4,500+ businesses.

Most credible expansion model

A regional collection / ITAD pilot or secure consolidation hub is more evidence-based than immediately proposing a full processing branch.

Possible progression:

1. scheduled Dubbo/Central West collection runs;
2. local secure aggregation;
3. authorised local operator/partner if Fliptech is willing;
4. local sanitisation/triage only after processes/security are approved;
5. full branch only if sustained volume proves the economics.

Unknown / must ask Fliptech

- Current number of regional NSW clients.
- Whether Fliptech already services Dubbo/Orange/Bathurst/Mudgee.
- Regional pickup minimums and collection economics.
- Whether regional work uses own fleet, freight or subcontractors.
- Whether Fliptech would consider an authorised regional operating partner.
- Whether a franchise/licensing model is intentionally excluded or simply undeveloped.
- Current reuse/resale percentage.
- Current annual tonnes and Brookvale capacity.
- Minimum monthly asset/tonnage threshold needed for a permanent Dubbo site.

P. Physical Dubbo ITAD branch / hub shortlist — 2 Oct 2026

Full staffing and branch-pattern evidence:

docs/AUSTRALIAN-ITAD-STAFFING-DUBBO-BRANCH-SHORTLIST.md
(docs/AUSTRALIAN-ITAD-STAFFING-DUBBO-BRANCH-SHORTLIST.md)

Important staffing correction

- [Found] Fliptech does not have a verified exact count of 11 staff. LinkedIn currently places Fliptech in the 11-50 employee band.
- [Found] G1 Asset Management is also in the 11-50 LinkedIn band, yet operates secure processing facilities in Brisbane, Sydney, Canberra and Melbourne and explicitly services metro and regional Australia.

- Implication: Fliptech's employee band by itself does not rule out a small Dubbo satellite.

Retained physical-branch/hub candidates

These are the companies with the strongest public evidence that a Dubbo physical presence is worth testing:

1. Fliptech Australia — strongest model fit; one current public site but historical national ambition/nationwide clients.
2. G1 Asset Management — 11-50 band; proven multi-facility specialist.
3. Renew IT — 51-200 LinkedIn band; company material has also said 200+ professionals; multi-depot Australian model.
4. Greenbox Group — 51-200; repeated branch expansion, four Australian facilities, formal partner program and historic regional roadshows.
5. WV Technologies — 51-200; locations in ACT, NSW, QLD, VIC and WA; buyback/refurbish/remarket model.
6. Shred-X — 201-500; 11 national facilities, three in NSW, explicit regional NSW coverage and growing ITAD/e-waste sales.
7. Iron Mountain / former ACT Logistics — ACT had a 51-200 band and multi-site Australian lifecycle operation before acquisition; Iron Mountain is actively expanding ALM in Australia/APAC.

Removed from the physical-branch shortlist

The following remain possible service providers, downstream partners or benchmarks, but current public evidence is not strong enough to prioritise them for a new Dubbo physical branch:

CirculaTech, Multi R IT, 9R Cycle IT, Tech ReCall, LinkBytes, ITC Asset Management, Excess Technology, EraseIT, Interlink Asset Management, ITSD, Secure Computer Recycling & Disposal, Recycle IT Australia, Enable IT Recycling, Sircel, Lifecycle Plus, WorkVentures, Total Green Recycling, Close the Loop and Sims Lifecycle Services.

This does not mean they would refuse Dubbo work. It means their public operating pattern currently points more strongly to remote service, logistics, partnership, a single processing centre, or a different strategic role than opening a new Dubbo branch.

Unanswered for all seven retained candidates

- Do they already service Dubbo / Central West NSW?
- How many recurring western NSW enterprise accounts do they have?
- What monthly device count or tonnes justify premises?
- Would they open an owned site, use a secure satellite, or approve a local operating partner?
- Can local sanitisation/refurbishment occur under their standards?
- What proportion of regional assets are reused/resold versus recycled?
- Would a Dubbo pilot be commercially preferable to existing Sydney/Canberra logistics?

Q. Branch-entry commercial unknowns

Detailed playbook:

- docs/DUBBO-ITAD-BRANCH-ENTRY-PLAYBOOK.md

Best low-cost entry paths found

- Greenbox: formal Partner Programme, co-branding/white-label/direct-client service, preferred pricing, training and asset-recovery margin; no public joining fee found.

- G1: explicit white-labelled ITAD for IT service providers and regional NSW coverage; no public white-label fee/margin schedule.
- Fliptech: no public partner/franchise system; strongest route is a negotiated 3-6 collection-cycle regional pilot.
- WV: commercial-partner category exists for secure logistics/component recovery; commercial terms private.
- Iron Mountain: global Build/Sell/Service partner program exists, but applicability to Australian ALM/ITAD physical service must be confirmed.
- Renew IT: no public franchise/channel process; Dubbo would need to be proposed as a last-mile/drop-off depot.
- Shred-X: no public franchise path; a Dubbo site would likely be a corporate branch or contractor depot.

Exact numbers now established

- Business name if needed: \$47/1yr.
- NSW second-hand dealer licence if applicable: \$692/1yr.
- Current 190 m² Dubbo industrial rent benchmark: \$395/week + GST = \$20,540/year + GST.
- Low-end commercial security benchmark: about \$5,000+.
- Blancco SMB Select 50 current reseller benchmark: \$982.30.
- National Minimum Wage: \$26.44/hr.
- One FTE minimum-wage base + 12% super: \$58,525.38/year.
- Modelled first-year secure-hub baseline before insurance/bond/outgoings/utilities/vehicle/racking/tools/labour: \$27,261.30.
- Same model plus one minimum-wage FTE: \$85,786.68 before those same unknowns.

Commercial terms still unknown

- Greenbox preferred pricing / actual partner margin.
- G1 white-label markup / reseller margin / buyback allocation.
- Fliptech local-operator revenue share.
- WV commercial-partner commercial terms.
- Iron Mountain ALM partner eligibility and margin.
- Renew IT local-depot operating arrangement.
- Shred-X contractor/corporate-branch structure.
- Required insurance limits for each parent.
- Whether any parent requires its own Blancco tenant/licences.
- Exact local security/fitout standard.
- Minimum recurring monthly device volume needed to justify premises.

Next evidence that matters most

1. Greenbox partner pricing/rulebook.
2. G1 white-label quote using the same 100-laptop sample job.
3. Fliptech written terms for a Dubbo/Central West pilot.

R. Branch economics — now quantified from public prices

Detailed file:

- docs/DUBBO-ITAD-BRANCH-PATHWAYS-COSTS-PROCESS.md

Branch economics — now quantified from public prices

- White-label/no-premises test: ABN \$0; business name \$47/year if needed.
- New proprietary company: \$636 registration; \$342 annual review; business name \$47 if required.
- Dubbo business storage: current advertised examples include 18 m² from \$125/month incl. GST and 32-36 m² from \$220/month incl. GST.
- Second-hand dealer licence if applicable: \$692 for one year.
- Current 200 m² Dubbo warehouse example: \$395/week + GST = \$22,594/year incl. GST.
- Blancco SMB Select 50 current Australian reseller listing: \$982.30.
- Owner-operated processing hub — known public-price subtotal: \$24,315.30/year before insurance, outgoings, bond, fitout, utilities, transport and vehicle.
- Hub + 20h casual legal wage/super floor: \$62,811.94/year before those missing costs.
- Hub + full-time legal wage/super floor: \$82,840.68/year before those missing costs.

Current lowest-risk sequence

1. G1 white-label or Greenbox partner.
2. Prove 3-10 recurring Dubbo business accounts.
3. Run collections with parent-company backend.
4. Add \$125-\$220/month secure staging only if logistics justify it and storage terms permit the exact use.
5. Add local sanitisation/testing only with written parent-company approval.
6. Sign a \$20k+ industrial lease only after recurring revenue supports it.

Still unknown

- Parent-company reseller/service pricing.
- Local operator commission or markup rights.
- Buyback/resale revenue split.
- Insurance premium and required cover limits.
- Lease bond/outgoings and fitout.
- Exact award classification for employees.
- Whether the partner company would fund premises/equipment itself.
- Whether geographic exclusivity is available.